

SilverTech Directory — Tour Guide

20 Questions to Ask on Your Residential Care Home Tour

Residential care homes — also called board and care homes — are small (typically 6 to 10 residents). The intimate setting is the appeal. These questions help you make sure the reality matches the promise.

Size, Staffing & Licensing

1. **How many residents currently live here, and what is the maximum licensed capacity?**
2. **How many staff are on duty during the day, evening, and overnight?**
3. **Is this home licensed by the state?** Can I see the current license and most recent inspection?
4. **How long has the owner/operator been running this home?**
5. **Who provides care if the primary caregiver is sick or on vacation?**

Care Capability

6. **What level of personal care can you provide?** (Bathing, dressing, toileting, transfers)
7. **How are medications managed and administered?** Are staff certified to handle medications?
8. **What medical conditions are you experienced with?** (Parkinson's, diabetes, post-surgical recovery)
9. **What conditions or care needs are beyond what you can handle?**
10. **Do you accept residents on hospice?**

Daily Life

11. **What does a typical day look like for residents?**

12. What meals are provided, and can dietary restrictions be accommodated?
13. Is the home smoke-free? Are pets allowed?
14. What activities or outings are available?
15. Can residents bring their own furniture and belongings?

Costs & Agreements

16. What is included in the monthly fee? Get the full list in writing.
17. What are the most common additional charges?
18. What is the move-out or discharge policy if care needs exceed what you can provide?
19. What happens to the monthly fee if a resident is hospitalized temporarily?

References & Transparency

20. Can I speak with a current resident's family member as a reference before I decide?

In a small home, the operator's character matters more than in a large facility. Trust your gut about the person running it.

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